

i. picture this

you are young, young enough that
you can look in the mirror and see
your grinning, toothy smile and not
indents and imperfections on foreign skin

it's a sunny day outside, and
you're in the library. arms weighed
down by a bag of books
your eyes will later pour over,
escaping the cries and screams
of a Lady You Do Not Know
from the next room over

hotel lights flicker, while
you think about those who once were
and you are far from home,
(you are always far from home)
when the Lady You Do Not Know tells you she
feels like you are her best friend, and
her arms wrap around yours and you wish
you could figure out how to scream again

you feel your lovelessness bleeding through the mundanity
of conversation, but she sits next to you in class,
a refuge from yourself,
the antithesis to the rest of your life,
and she is kind and loved, and you want
to brush your fingers through her hair
and she calls your name and the world
tips below your feet, but you stay
in place because you know love
is for beautiful people,
anyway.